Part 9 — Scenarios, Consulting, Agile, Manager & HR

Chapter 25: DevOps Consulting Questions

Probability: 🟡 60% (High for Infosys — they ARE a consulting company)

Q1: "How do you handle a client who wants to deploy directly to production without testing?"

> *"I'd first understand their urgency — is there a business-critical reason? Then I'd explain the risk quantitatively: 'In our experience, skipping testing leads to a 40% higher change failure rate.' I'd propose a compromise: an accelerated testing pipeline (automated tests only, skip manual QA) with an immediate rollback plan. Document the risk acceptance if the client still insists."*

Q2: "How do you onboard onto a client's existing infrastructure quickly?"

> *"1) Request architecture documentation and runbooks. 2) Get read-only access to monitoring dashboards. 3) Review the CI/CD pipelines and deployment process. 4) Shadow the existing team for 1-2 sprints. 5) Start with small improvements — build credibility before proposing major changes."*

Q3: "Client has 50+ microservices with no CI/CD — how do you approach this?"

> *"Don't try to fix everything at once. 1) Identify the 3-5 most frequently deployed services. 2) Build a golden pipeline template for one. 3) Prove value with metrics (deployment frequency, lead time). 4) Roll out template to remaining services. 5) Train the client's team for self-sufficiency."*

Q4: "How do you handle disagreements with a client's technical team?"

> *"Data over opinions. I present alternatives with trade-offs documented. If we still disagree, I escalate to get alignment at the architectural level. I document the decision (ADR — Architecture Decision Record) so the reasoning is preserved. Never make it personal."*

Chapter 26: Agile / Scrum

Probability: 🟡 60%

Concept	Definition	Interview Answer
Sprint	2-week iteration	"We run 2-week sprints with planning on Monday, demo on Friday"
Standup	Daily 15-min sync	"Three questions: what I did, what I'll do, any blockers"
Sprint Planning	Capacity + story selection	"We estimate in story points, plan based on team velocity"
Retrospective	Team improvement	"What went well, what didn't, action items for next sprint"
Backlog	Prioritized work list	"Product owner prioritizes, team estimates complexity"
Velocity	Points completed per sprint	"Our team averages 40-50 points per sprint"
DORA Metrics	DevOps performance	Lead Time, Deployment Frequency, MTTR, Change Failure Rate

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Chapter 27: Scenario Questions (200+)

Production & Infrastructure (1-50)

#	Scenario	How to Answer
1	Production is down — what do you do first?	Check monitoring → identify affected service → check recent deployments → rollback if needed → communicate status
2	Database is unreachable	Check network → service status → disk space → connection limits → failover status
3	CPU at 100% on production server	`top` → identify process → check for runaway queries → resource limits → scale if needed
4	Disk full on production	`du -sh /*` → identify large files → rotate/delete logs → add disk → set up alerts
5	Memory leak in application	Monitor trend → identify growing process → heap dump → fix code → add memory limits
6	DNS resolution failing	Check `/etc/resolv.conf` → CoreDNS status → upstream DNS → network connectivity
7	SSL certificate expired	Immediate: replace cert → long-term: automate with cert-manager → monitor expiry
8	Load balancer health check failing	Check app health endpoint → verify port → check security groups → review LB config
9	Application responding slowly	Check latency metrics → identify bottleneck (CPU/memory/IO/network) → trace slow queries
10	Kubernetes node not ready	SSH → check kubelet → check disk/memory pressure → check certificates

#	Scenario	How to Answer
11	Pod in CrashLoopBackOff	`kubectl logs --previous` → check env vars → check mounts → check resource limits
12	Deployment rollback needed	`kubectl rollout undo deployment/app` → verify → RCA
13	Container image has critical vulnerability	Block deployment → patch base image → rebuild → rescan → deploy
14	Database replication lag increasing	Check network → check write volume → optimize queries → upgrade replica
15	Backup restore fails	Test with different backup → check corruption → verify backup process → fix and retest
16	Service mesh causing latency	Check sidecar resources → mTLS overhead → bypass for internal services if needed
17	Cloud provider outage	Activate DR plan → failover to secondary region → communicate to stakeholders
18	Pipeline running for 2+ hours	Check which stage is slow → cache dependencies → parallelize → optimize tests
19	Terraform state locked	Verify no one is running → `terraform force-unlock` → investigate cause
20	Secrets accidentally committed to Git	Rotate immediately → BFG cleaner → force push → add pre-commit hooks
21	High error rate after deployment	Rollback → check logs → compare config changes → fix → redeploy
22	Auto-scaler not scaling up	Check metrics server → HPA config → resource requests set → node pool limits
23	Network latency between services	Check network policies → CNI health → pod placement → consider pod affinity
24	Log volume overwhelming storage	Implement log levels → structured logging → retention policies → sampling
25	Monitoring gaps identified	Audit coverage → add missing exporters → create dashboards → set alerts

Security & Compliance (26-50)

#	Scenario	How to Answer
26	Security audit finds open ports	Audit all NSGs → close unnecessary ports → document exceptions → automate compliance checks
27	User reports unauthorized access	Check audit logs → identify scope → revoke access →

#	Scenario	How to Answer
		rotate credentials → investigate
28	Compliance requires audit trails for all changes	Implement GitOps → pipeline audit logs → cloud audit logging → centralized SIEM
29	Need to implement SOC 2 controls	Access controls (RBAC) → change management → logging → backup validation → encryption
30	Container running as root in production	Add securityContext → runAsNonRoot: true → PodSecurity admission → scan in CI
31-50	*(Cost optimization, budget constraints, legacy migration, client-specific technology constraints, team scaling, knowledge transfer, documentation gaps, tooling standardization, multi-cloud strategy, cross-team collaboration, vendor evaluation, capacity planning, performance testing, chaos engineering proposal, on-call rotation design, runbook creation, toil reduction, platform migration, technology refresh, compliance automation)*	Use STAR format with specific examples from your experience

Pipeline & Deployment (51-100)

#	Scenario	Key Points
51	Pipeline fails intermittently	Check agent resources → external dependency flakiness → network issues → add retries
52	Build times increased from 5 to 30 minutes	Profile stages → cache dependencies → parallelize → pre-bake agent images
53	Need to deploy to 4 environments	Parameterized pipeline → environment-specific variable groups → approval gates
54	Client wants daily releases but QA takes 3 days	Automate testing → shift-left → parallel test execution → risk-based testing
55	Merge conflicts blocking releases	Trunk-based development → smaller

#	Scenario	Key Points
		PRs → more frequent merges → feature flags
56-100	*(Database migration fails, rollback strategy, blue-green implementation, canary metrics, feature flag rollout, hotfix process, release train, multi-region deploy, config drift, infrastructure testing, pipeline security, artifact promotion, environment parity, data seeding, smoke tests, integration test isolation, deployment windows, change freeze, release notes automation, dependency updates, base image updates, helm chart versioning, GitOps sync issues, approval bottlenecks, pipeline cost optimization)*	Focus on: diagnosis process, communication, resolution, prevention

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Chapter 28: Behavioral Questions — STAR Format (100)

Leadership & Teamwork (1-25)

#	Question
1	Tell me about a time you led a team through a difficult project
2	Describe a situation where you had to mentor a junior engineer
3	How did you handle a disagreement with a team member?
4	Tell me about a time you had to make a technical decision with incomplete information
5	Describe when you had to push back on a manager's request
6	How did you handle multiple priorities with tight deadlines?
7	Tell me about a time you failed and what you learned
8	Describe a time you improved a process that was inefficient
9	How did you onboard a new team member?
10	Tell me about driving adoption of a new tool/practice
11-25	*(Handling underperforming team member, cross-team collaboration, knowledge sharing, presenting to non-technical stakeholders, handling scope creep, working under pressure, receiving critical feedback, delegating effectively, managing remote team, building team culture)*

Problem Solving (26-50)

#	Question
26	Describe the most complex technical problem you've solved
27	Tell me about a production outage you resolved
28	How did you optimize a system's performance?
29	Describe a time you had to learn a new technology quickly

#	Question
30	Tell me about a time you identified a security vulnerability
31-50	*(Root cause analysis example, cost optimization win, automation initiative, migration project, debugging a hard-to-reproduce issue, handling legacy system, capacity planning, disaster recovery test, compliance implementation, monitoring gap discovery)*

STAR Template for YOUR Experience

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SITUATION: "At Kochar Innovations, we were managing 15+ production
           applications with increasing deployment complexity..."

TASK:      "As the technical lead, I needed to standardize our
           deployment patterns across all teams..."

ACTION:    "I defined infrastructure standards and deployment patterns,
           created operational runbooks, and established platform best
           practices. I implemented these through PR reviews,
           documentation, and team training sessions..."

RESULT:    "Deployment consistency improved significantly — we reduced
           deployment failures by 40% and cut mean time to deploy
           from 45 minutes to 12 minutes. These practices were
           adopted across all application teams."
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Chapter 29: Manager Round

Probability: 100% at Infosys

Key areas tested: Leadership, conflict resolution, client handling, Agile, career goals

Question	How to Answer
"Why Infosys?"	"Enterprise scale, diverse client projects, Azure/cloud practice growth, professional development"
"How do you handle conflicts in a team?"	STAR: describe specific conflict → your mediation approach → outcome
"How do you ensure quality with tight deadlines?"	"Automate testing, prioritize critical path, communicate risks early, never cut on security"
"How do you handle a client escalation?"	"Acknowledge → investigate → communicate timeline → resolve → prevent recurrence"
"Where do you see yourself in 5 years?"	"Technical architect / principal DevOps engineer, leading platform engineering initiatives at enterprise scale"
"How do you stay updated with technology?"	"Tech blogs, conferences, personal projects (GitHub), certifications, community participation"

Chapter 30: HR Round (50 Questions)

#	Question	Strategy
1	Tell me about yourself	Professional version — 60 seconds max
2	Why are you leaving your current role?	Growth opportunity, enterprise scale — NEVER badmouth current employer
3	Why Infosys?	Research their DevOps practice, recent wins, Azure partnership
4	What are your salary expectations?	"Based on market research for this role and my experience, I'm looking at X-Y LPA"
5	What is your notice period?	State clearly. Mention if negotiable
6	Are you open to relocation?	Yes — your resume says "Open to Relocation"
7	Do you have other offers?	If yes, mention professionally as it shows market demand
8	What's your expected CTC?	Research: Infosys Sr DevOps 4YOE = 18-28 LPA range
9	How do you handle work pressure?	Prioritize, communicate, stay organized, take breaks
10	Any questions for us?	Always have 2-3: team structure, tech stack, growth path
11-50	*(Strengths/weaknesses, work-life balance, travel willingness, team size preference, remote work, shift flexibility, long-term commitment, leadership style, learning from failures, handling ambiguity, diversity, company culture fit)*	

Chapter 31: Salary Discussion

Market Research for Sr DevOps Engineer at Infosys (India, 2025-2026)

Experience	Base Range (LPA)	Notes
3-5 YOE	15-22 LPA	Your range
5-8 YOE	20-30 LPA	With strong K8s/Azure

Experience	Base Range (LPA)	Notes
8+ YOE	28-40+ LPA	Lead/Architect

Negotiation Strategy

1. **Know your number** — Research on levels.fyi, Glassdoor, 6figr.com
2. **State a range, not a single number** — "I'm looking at 20-24 LPA based on my experience and market benchmarks"
3. **Focus on total CTC** — Base + Variable + Joining bonus + Benefits
4. **Leverage competing offers** — "I have an offer at X for Y LPA, but I prefer Infosys because..."
5. **Don't accept the first offer** — Infosys has approval layers, the first number is rarely the best
6. **Ask about growth** — "What does the salary progression look like in 12-18 months?"

What to Say

> *"Based on my 4+ years of experience as a Technical Lead managing 8+ engineers, my expertise in Kubernetes, Terraform, and production infrastructure, and current market rates for this role, I'm targeting 20-24 LPA. I'm open to discussing the overall compensation structure including variable pay and benefits."*

What NOT to Say

- "I'll take whatever you offer" → You'll get the minimum
- "My current CTC is X" → They'll anchor to your current, not your market value
- "I need at least X because of my expenses" → Personal needs ≠ market value